

4 Conclusion



4.1 Hacking... Anything

While we have been focusing on web, the networks and information security in this Fast Track, this is not what hacking is all about. We have tried to make this quite clear in the introduction of this book. After reading this book, you should not limit yourself to thinking of hacking purely in terms of security and computers. There is a whole world out there waiting to be hacked.

While most of the situations we have covered require that the application design be tightened, and support fewer parameters, sometimes applications are better off if they are hackable. Mozilla Firefox is a brilliant example of this.

Nearly every part of the application is configurable; while other browsers are allowing introducing features such as jump lists and tab previews, Firefox is the only browser to allow one to turn these features off, and control how they function – although this particular feature is only in the unreleased versions. Each and every aspect of the Firefox UI can be altered with ease. Chances are if you don't like the way Firefox handles something you will find a setting to turn it off or change it from `about:config`.

The Firefox UI is described in plain text format with a language called XUL. A large portion of its functionality comes from code written in JavaScript, which is editable by the end user. Firefox is hackable to the core. While exposing this to each and every user would just complicate matters for